# Haiyue **Song**



## Profile

Haiyue Song received his bachelor's degree in computer science and technology, with a minor in Japanese, from Shanghai Jiao Tong University, China, in 2018, followed by his master's degree in intelligence science and technology in 2020, Ph.D. in informatics in 2024, from Kyoto University, Japan.

He worked as a Technical Researcher at the National Institute of Information and Communications Technology (NICT) from July 2023 to March 2026. Since April 2026, he has been working as an LLM Post-Training Engineer at Preferred Networks, Japan.

## Research interests

Multilingual, Multicultural and Multimodal LLMs.
Pre-, Middle-, and Post-Training Methods in LLMs.

## Working languages

Japanese, and English.

## Contact details

@ haiyue.song.nlp@gmail.com
宋 shyyhs.github.io

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## Work Experience

**Preferred Networks, Inc.**
*LLM Development Department*
*Engineer* **Apr. 2026–Present**

◇ I post-train our Japanese LLM PLaMo. Specifically, I contribute to reinforcement learning, long-context capabilities, and agent harness development. In the PLaMo 3.0 Prime release, we doubled the number of reinforcement learning steps and extended the context length from 64K to 256K tokens. [Release blog]

◇ I also work on continual pre-training for adapting PLaMo to new languages, covering data collection, training, and evaluation.

**National Institute of Information and Communications Technology**
*Advanced Science and Technology Research Center for Multimodal AI Communication, Multilingual and Multicultural Communication Lab.*
*Technical Researcher* **July 2023–Mar. 2026**

◇ I adapted Gemma to Japanese and ASEAN languages through our novel model merging based approach, OptiMer. We show it is effective, efficient, and flexible with benchmark results and thorough analysis. This work is accepted to **EMNLP 2026** as an Oral and won the **Outstanding Paper Award**.

◇ I developed a cultural awareness benchmark and metric: I contributed half of the Japanese subset of CVQA; An intern and I proposed ExCAM, an automatic metric that detects cultural errors in LLM outputs with not only scores but also explanations, which is accepted to Findings of EMNLP 2026.

◇ I worked on multimodal translation, including speech translation and translation with video information. Our work on cascaded and end-to-end speech translation systems using Whisper and IndicTrans2 ranked first in the Indic speech translation track at IWSLT 2024. Earlier work includes video-guided text translation and translating text in images and videos.

## Education

**Kyoto University**

◇ Advisors: Sadao Kurohashi and Chenhui Chu
Ph.D. in Informatics **Oct. 2020–Mar. 2024**
Master in Intelligence Science and Technology **Oct. 2018–Sept. 2020**

**Shanghai Jiao Tong University** **Sept. 2014–July 2018**

◇ Advisor: Li Jiang
Bachelor in Computer Science and Technology
Minor in Japanese, School of Foreign Languages

## Selected Publications

**OptiMer: Optimal Distribution Vector Merging Is Better than Data Mixing for Continual Pre-Training**

**Haiyue Song**, Huy Hien Vu, and Masao Utiyama.

*EMNLP 2026 Main Conference.*

Outstanding Paper Award | Oral

**Is Human Annotation Necessary? Iterative MBR Distillation for Error Span Detection in Machine Translation**

Boxuan Lyu, **Haiyue Song**, and Zhi Qu.

*Findings of EMNLP 2026.*

**ExCAM: Explainable Cultural Awareness Metrics**

Christoph Leiter, **Haiyue Song**, Hour Kaing, Jin Tei, Hideki Tanaka, Masao Utiyama, and Steffen Eger.

*Findings of EMNLP 2026.*

**DiverSeg: Leveraging Diverse Segmentations with Cross-granularity Alignment for Neural Machine Translation**

**Haiyue Song**, Zhuoyuan Mao, Raj Dabre, Chenhui Chu, and Sadao Kurohashi.

*Journal of Natural Language Processing, 2024.*

**Structured Document Translation via Format Reinforcement Learning**

**Haiyue Song**, Johannes Eschbach-Dymanus, Hour Kaing, Sumire Honda, Hideki Tanaka, Bianka Buschbeck, and Masao Utiyama.

*IJCNLP-AACL 2025 Main Conference.*

Oral

**CVQA: Culturally-diverse Multilingual Visual Question Answering Benchmark**

David Romero, Chenyang Lyu, Haryo Akbarianto Wibowo, ..., **Haiyue Song**, ...

*NeurIPS 2024 Datasets and Benchmarks Track.*

Oral

**NICT's Cascaded and End-To-End Speech Translation Systems using Whisper and IndicTrans2 for the Indic Task**

Raj Dabre and **Haiyue Song**.

*IWSLT 2024. Indic speech translation track.*

1st Place

## Tutorials

**Connecting Ideas in "Lower-Resource" Scenarios**

Aditya Joshi, Diptesh Kanojia, Heather Lent, Hour Kaing, and **Haiyue Song**.

COLING 2025.

**Linguistically Motivated Neural Machine Translation**

**Haiyue Song**, Hour Kaing, and Raj Dabre.

EAMT 2024.

## Professional Activities

**Academic Service**

Area Chair: ACL Rolling Review (2025, 2026).

Organizing Committee Member (Website Chair), EMNLP 2025.

Organizer: WAT 2024 and WAT 2025.

Reviewer: ACL, EMNLP, NAACL, EACL, COLING, IJCNLP, AACL, LREC, MT Summit, EAMT, TASLP, TALLIP, IEICE, JNLP, WAT, etc.

**Research Funding**

Grant-in-Aid for Early-Career Scientists (2025–2026).

JSPS Research Fellowship for Young Scientists (DC1; 2021–2023).

**Research Leadership**

Led research collaborations with institutions in Germany and Singapore; mentored four research interns from Japan and abroad.

**Competitive Programming**

Silver medal in National Olympiad in Informatics (NOI), China, 2013.

Bronze medal in Asia-Pacific Informatics Olympiad (APIO), 2013.